

A SMALL, USEFUL FIRST STEP

AI Follow-Up Starter Kit

Turn meeting notes into a clearer next step - without letting AI invent the details.

01 A simple input sheet

02 Five copy-and-adapt prompts

03 A worked example and pre-send checklist

Start with one follow-up.

Choose a task you already understand. Give the AI accurate notes, ask for a bounded draft, and check the output before it reaches a customer. You stay responsible for the message.

No special AI subscription is required by this guide. Use a tool you already have access to and follow its current data settings and terms.

01 / SET UP THE TASK

Good output starts with good inputs.

Fill in this sheet before writing a prompt. Use fictional or approved information while you learn; remove private details that the task does not need.

The customer situation (one sentence)

The outcome I want from this message

Facts, decisions, and commitments we actually confirmed

Open questions or details I still need to check

Tone, length, and the one next action

Add this boundary to every prompt

Use only the information I supply. Do not invent prices, deadlines, agreement, results, or promises. Put missing details in a separate "Needs checking" list. Draft only; do not send anything.

Before using real client information, check your tool settings and whether you are permitted to use that information. A prompt instruction alone is not a privacy control.

02 / UNDERSTAND BEFORE DRAFTING

Prompts 1 & 2

Replace the bracketed inputs. Keep the same fact boundary as you move from one step to the next.

1. Turn rough notes into a useful brief

Organize the notes below into four sections: confirmed facts, agreed actions, open questions, and possible next steps. For agreed actions, show the owner and deadline only if the notes state them. Label possible next steps as suggestions, not commitments. Use only the supplied notes; flag contradictions and missing details.

NOTES: [Paste your approved notes.]

2. Draft the first follow-up

Using the brief below, draft a friendly client follow-up email of no more than 120 words. Include a short subject line, the relevant confirmed points, and one clear question or next action. Do not invent a price, deadline, agreement, or promise. Keep assumptions out of the email and list anything I must check separately. Draft only; do not send.

BRIEF: [Paste the reviewed brief.]

TONE: [e.g., direct, warm, plain English.]

Your review

- [] The brief correctly separates a discussion from an agreement.
- [] The draft asks for something the recipient can actually answer.
- [] All names, dates, prices, and commitments match the source notes.

03 / MAKE IT EASIER TO ACT

Prompts 3 & 4

Use these only after you have checked the underlying facts. A better sentence cannot fix a false claim.

3. Make the message clearer

Edit the draft below for clarity. Keep the factual meaning and all confirmed dates and commitments unchanged. Remove filler, jargon, pressure, and repeated ideas. Use short paragraphs and one clear call to action. Return the edited email, then a short list of any meaning changes or unsupported claims you noticed. Do not add new facts.

DRAFT: [Paste the draft.]

CONFIRMED FACTS: [Paste the source facts.]

4. Write a respectful reminder

Draft one brief follow-up to the message below. Do not assume the person saw it, is interested, or owes me a reply. Restate the useful context in one sentence and ask one simple question. Avoid guilt, false urgency, scarcity, or invented deadlines. Keep it under 75 words. Draft only; do not send.

EARLIER MESSAGE: [Paste the approved message.]

NEW CONFIRMED INFORMATION, IF ANY: [Add it or write "none".]

A useful restraint

More messages are not automatically better. Respect opt-outs and your recipient relationship. Choose whether and when a follow-up is appropriate before using the draft.

04 / CHECK THE RESULT

Prompt 5: the pre-send review

Ask for a review, then verify it yourself. A second AI response can repeat the same mistake.

5. Compare the draft against the facts

Compare the draft with the source notes. List each factual claim and say whether it is supported, contradicted, or not stated. Check names, dates, prices, commitments, implied agreement, and the requested next step. Flag private details that are unnecessary. Do not silently repair missing facts or approve the email for sending. End with the questions a human should resolve.

SOURCE NOTES: [Paste your approved notes.]

DRAFT: [Paste the candidate email.]

Your final check

- ☐ The name and contact details are correct.
- ☐ Every deadline and promise is something I can stand behind.
- ☐ The message does not imply a price or agreement we never made.
- ☐ The reader can identify the one next step.
- ☐ No unnecessary private information is included.
- ☐ The tone fits the relationship, and sending is appropriate.

If any answer is uncertain, resolve it before sending. Save the final approved draft separately from the AI conversation.

A fictional example, worked through.

This example is illustrative. It is not a client result, a tested performance claim, or a transcript of a live AI response.

The rough notes

Maya runs a local landscaping business. She wants a simpler way to follow up after quote requests. We discussed a website inquiry form and a weekly review of incoming requests. I will send a rough outline by Thursday. No price or start date was agreed. Open question: who will review inquiries each week?

A reviewed draft

Subject: Next step for your quote follow-up

Hi Maya, thanks for walking me through your quote-request process. We discussed a website inquiry form and a weekly review of new requests. I will send a rough outline by Thursday.

Who on your team would review the inquiries each week?

Why this draft is useful

It repeats only what the notes support. It preserves the one stated commitment. It avoids turning a discussion into a sale. It ends with the unanswered operational question.

What still needs a human check

Confirm the name and deadline, decide whether the tone fits, and check that Thursday still means the date both people expect. The example deliberately leaves out a price and start date because neither was agreed.

06 / PUT IT TO WORK

Use the kit on one real task.

Keep the scope small enough to judge the result yourself.

Choose

Pick one routine follow-up you understand. Avoid sensitive or high-stakes work while learning.

Draft

Complete the input sheet. Use prompts 1 and 2, then refine only if the draft needs it.

Check

Run the comparison in prompt 5. Resolve every unsupported claim and do your own final review.

Improve

Notice what you had to correct. Add that missing context to your next input sheet.

Ready for the next step?

Watch practical demonstrations at the free 3-day AI for Business Summit. Check the registration page for the next dates and details.

Reserve your free Summit pass

Explore training and app-building templates at brianhanson.com/shop.

Use the prompts and worksheets for your own work and client work. Do not resell or redistribute the original kit as your own. Educational use; no particular business result is promised. Version 1.0 - September 2026.

Further reading: NIST, AI Risk Management Framework: Generative AI Profile (NIST AI 600-1). The kit is original practical material, not a NIST certification or endorsement.